UTAH COURT OF APPEALS
PO Box 140230
Salt Lake City, UT 84114-0230

CASE NUMBER

**20190277**

*Appellee:*
MACAELA DANYELE DAY

*vs.*

*Appellant:*
TYLER BARNES

*Counsel for Appellant:*
Theodore R. Weckel, Jr.

*Counsel for Appellee:*
Eric B. Barnes

# APPELLANT'S PRINCIPAL BRIEF

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## CERTIFICATE OF COMPLIANCE

I certify that this brief complies with the requirements of 24(f)(1) and 21(g) of the Utah Rules of Appellate Procedure (URAP), including:

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I understand that my brief may be rejected if I fail to comply with these rules.

s/ Theodore R. Weckel
Counsel for Appellant

## INTRODUCTION

A Massachusetts resident seeks to return with her child after turning over custody to a Utah resident by coercion. This case was originally brought as a Uniform Child Custody Jurisdiction Enforcement Act action (hereinafter referred to as "UCCJEA"). This court in Day v. Barnes, 2018 UT App. 143, 427 P.3d 1272, ruled that the judge erred by imposing a burden upon Appellant to prove that the commissioner's recommendation was erroneous under Civil Rule 108. Upon remand, the judge relied upon his 2014 findings from a temporary order in the UCCJEA hearing – which had merged with a final order in the UCCJEA action – to rule against relocation. Appellant contends that the relocation hearing violated her right to procedural due process.

## STATEMENT OF ISSUES

1. Whether the relocation hearing denied Appellant due process? The standard of review is de novo. Hogge v. Hogge, 649 P.2d 51, 54 (UT 1982). This issue was preserved during the court's relocation hearing, (R. 2221, 17-25; R. 2222, 6-7; R. 2225-26; R. 2227, 1-18; R. 2228, 4-5, 9-10, R. 2228, 15-18, R. 2231, 1-17; R. 2564, 18-25, 2565, l. 1-10 and tacitly by motion. R. 1323.
2. Whether the court's findings of fact are legally deficient? The standard of review is clearly erroneous. Robertson v. Robertson, 2016 UT App. 55, ¶5, 370

P.3d 569. This issue was preserved when Appellant filed her objection to the Commissioner's recommendation, R. 2046-55.

3. Whether the court ruling on relocation was erroneous? The standard of review for a determination of custody is abuse of discretion. Id. at 573, ¶9. Since the issue challenges the Court's ultimate ruling, it is inherently preserved.

## STATEMENT OF THE CASE

On May 1, 2013, Appellant filed a child custody petition under the UCCJEA. In 2012, Appellee had filed a custody action in Massachusetts where the child and Appellant had been living with her family. The commissioner determined that Massachusetts was the home state of the child. R. 432. The commissioner indicated that he would consult with the Court in Massachusetts regarding convenient forum. Appellee dismissed his Massachusetts action. The parties agreed that Utah had subject matter jurisdiction. R. 600.

Argument before the commissioner regarding temporary custody occurred on October 1, 2013. On November 22, 2013, the commissioner entered his recommendation. He allowed Appellant one week of parent-time in Massachusetts every six weeks, and joint physical custody during her college breaks. Appellant objected.

On March 20 and 21, 2014, the judge held an evidentiary hearing. On April 25, 2014, the judge entered his written findings and temporary order. R. 1052.

On December 4, 2014, Appellant moved under Civil Rule 54(b) and the law of the case doctrine to modify the court's temporary order. R. 1323. Rather than ruling on the motion, the court scheduled a Rule 4-903 conference.

On February 24, 2015, the parties met for the conference. The custody evaluator, Dr. Matthew Davies, appeared and presented his prospective recommendations to the parties. The parties reached a stipulation. The stipulation was entered as a final order on June 18, 2015.

Appellant relocated to Utah in July of 2015 to become the primary caregiver under the terms of final order. She attended college through distance learning. Due to continued wrangling with Appellee, on November 10, 2015, Appellant moved to relocate to Massachusetts.

On January 21, 2016, the commissioner heard oral argument on relocation. The commissioner denied Appellant's motion. Appellant objected.

On July 6 and 8, 2016, the judge held an evidentiary hearing on Appellant's objection. He denied the motion from the bench. On October 19, 2016, the court entered its written findings and order. R. 1959.

Appellant filed her notice of appeal on November 17, 2016. Appellee filed a notice of cross-appeal on December 1, 2016.

On July 27, 2018, this court issued an opinion which required remand, finding that the judge had misapplied Civil Rule 108.

Upon remand, the judge heard oral argument. The court issued its ruling on February 20, 2019. Appellant filed a timely notice of appeal on March 22, 2019.

## STATEMENT OF THE FACTS

### *A. THE RELOCATION RULING.*

The female child, A.D., was born on December 10, 2010. R. 34. During the presentation of Appellant's first witness at the evidentiary hearing, the court ruled that it would not receive evidence that had occurred prior to its temporary order entered on April 25, 2014. Faced with the court's ruling, Appellant's asked the court if it would at least allow the transcript of the hearing held on April 25, 2014, to be made part of the relocation record. R. 2221, 17-25; R. 2222, 6-7; R. 2225, 1-2; R. 2226, 12-25; R. 2228, 4-5, 9-10, R. 2228, 15-18, R. 2231, 1-17; R. 2564, 18-25, 2565, l. 1-10. The judge agreed. In the judge's final order on relocation, he incorporated by reference his prior findings and rulings filed on April 25, 2014. R. 1961-62.

In the UCCJEA matter, the commissioner's initial recommended ruling either found or acknowledged that: (1) the child had lived for 28 ½ months in Appellant's home; (2) the parties allowed Appellee to gain physical custody of the child seven months before the recommendation was issued "for one reason or another"; and, (3) Appellant had a significant role in caring for the child ( R. 737-38).

The findings entered on April 25, 2014, stated that: (1) Appellee's had a history of lower standards of moral behavior than Petitioner and the testimony in that regard was significant, R. 1059, 1064; (2) the court was concerned about Appellee's overly restrictive approach to parent-time, R. 1060; (3) because of the parties' and the child's ties to Utah, the child should remain in Utah, R. 1062, ¶18; and, (4) because Appellant elected to finish her college education in Boston while living with her parents, she did not give first priority to raising her child, R. 1060, ¶15.

***B. THE EVIDENCE AT THE UCCJEA EVIDENTIARY HEARING***

At the evidentiary hearing held on March 20, 2014, Appellant testified about how she had felt coerced by Appellee's and his family's threats, and her lawyer's ineffectiveness in deciding to turn over custody of the parties' child to Appellee, R. 2946-47; R. 2951, l. 9-25; R. 2952, l. 1-4. She stated that: (1) in the fall of 2012, Appellee had filed a law suit in Massachusetts to try and gain custody of the child, R. 2950, 15-180; (2) her attorney had informed her that Appellee's family was going to take legal action against her mother, and that her mother would go to jail if she did not sign over custody, R. 2947, 18-20, R. 2951, 24-25; (3) Appellee had told Appellant that his family was going to try to have Appellee's mother prosecuted for molesting him if she did not sign over custody; (4) Appellant's mother had told Appellant that Appellee had forced her to have sex with him

several times, R. 2945, l. 21-25; (5) Appellee told Appellant approximately ten times in 2013 that his father was going to try to have Appellee's mother prosecuted for having sex with him, R. 2946, l. 17; (6) Appellant was worried about Appellant's threats of prosecuting her mother, R. 2979, l. 23-25; R. 2980, 1-5; (8) Appellant's mom is her best friend, and the child also has a close relationship with Appellant's mom, R. 2954, l. 7-8; (9) during a mediation in April of 2013, when Appellant's lawyer told her forcefully that unless she signed over custody, Appellant's mother would be prosecuted, Appellant became frightened, went along with her lawyer's advice, and signed over custody, R. 2954, l. 17-21; (10) Appellant's lawyer was on Lortab during the mediation, and it seemed to Appellant that her lawyer "was not all there," R. 2955, l. 13-25; (11) deleted (12) Appellee's family tried to pressure her to sign over custody of the child, R. 2959, l. 20-25); (13) Appellee's father is an attorney, and despite being represented by counsel, Appellee's father talked to her about settling the case prior to the mediation, R. 2997, l. 5-14; (14) Appellee had lied about her mother molesting him, about him not raping her, and about how he had sexually assaulted her mother in public, R. 2957, l. 1-12; and, (15) Appellee has a pornography addiction, R. 2938, 8-13.

Appellant also testified as follows: (1) Appellant had run away from home because his parents had verbally abused him, R. 2938, l. 25, R. 2939, l. 1; (2) Appellee's parents put him in a mental health facility twice, R. 2982; and, (3)

Appellee had wanted to commit suicide, R. 2994, l. 4-8. The commissioner's recommendation omitted these facts. R. 821.

Appellant cared for the child when she was not at college, R. 2948, l. 14. Appellee paid little child support, R. 2958, l. 13-15. When she was at classes her maternal grandmother and great aunt tended the child, R. 2949, l. 25; R. 2950, l. 1-2. The parties moved to Massachusetts when the child was one year old, R. 1958, l. 5-9. Appellee had no contact with the child for at least six months after he had moved back to Utah, R. 1958, l. 5-9. Appellee paid about $100 in child support over the year before the mediation, and paid nothing in the way of medical insurance premiums or out-of-pocket medical expenses, R. 2958, l. 17.

Appellant also testified that: (1) Appellee had raped her 20-30 times, R. 2936, l. 2-6; (2) Appellee touched her butt about 100 times without permission, R. 2936, l. 18; (3) Appellant found Appellee naked in bed with her best friend, R. 2937, l. 18-22; (4) Appellant found Appellee looking at pornography every night for two years, R. 1993, 12-25; (5) Appellant observed Appellee walking naked in her residence, R. 2942, l. 4-7; (6) Appellant observed Appellee groping her mother's breasts, R. 2942, l. 12-25; (7) the State of Massachusetts had expressed an interest in prosecuting Appellee, R. 2989, l. 21-25 - R. 1299, l. 1-4.

Appellant wanted to facilitate a close relationship between the child and Appellee, R. 2959, l. 15. She was denied her full, one week parent-time due to

having to use up two travel days to travel from Massachusetts to Utah, R. 2961, l. 7-14. Appellee intruded into Appellant's virtual parent-time, R. 2961, l. 19-21. Appellee denied her parent-time when the child was visiting Massachusetts, R. 2967, l. 7-15. Appellant wanted to complete her college degree so she could support the child, R. 2969, l. 14-15. Appellee did not communicate with her about the child when he returned to Utah, R. 2969, l. 16-25; R. 2970, l. 1-13.

Appellant also testified as follows: (1) her mother had told her that Appellee had taken advantage of her multiple times, R. 3392, l. 20-25; (2) she described her home as not sexually charged, R. 3393, l. 8-17; (3) Appellee raped her repeatedly, R. 3394-96; (4) Appellee never tried to arrange for parent-time when he had moved to Utah, R. 3396, l. 14-20; and, (5) she did not report the rapes because she was trying to fix him and because she was scared of him, R. 3397, l. 8-12.

At the UCCJEA hearing, Jaime Day, Appellant's mother, testified as follows: (1) Appellee would flirtatiously swat her butt, R. 3007, l. 23-25; R. 3008, l. 1-19; (2) Appellee touched her breasts without consent, R. 3008, l. 22-25; R. 3009, l. 1-2; (3) Appellee filed a police report against her for allegedly molesting him, R. 3009, l. 19-24; R. 3013, l. 1-2; (4) while she was sleeping in her bed one night, Appellee got on top of her, told her that she needed to feel what it was like to be loved like she had never been loved before, then threatened her with prosecution if she told anyone what he did, R. 3015, l. 15-25; R. 3016; (5) her attempts to push Appellee

off failed, R. 3016; (6) she has seen psychotherapists about the rape incident, R. 3016, l. 24; (7) Appellee invited her to watch pornography with him, R. 3017, l. 13-18; (8) she observed Appellee walking naked daily, R. 3017, l. 22-25; R. 3018, l. 1-6; (9) Appellee reported that his father was mentally abusive, R. 3020, 10-11; (10) Appellee ran away from home, R. 3021, l. 4-7; (11) she felt that her family needed to protect Appellee, R. 3021, 14; (12) the police took him to a juvenile mental health facility, R. 3021, 22-25; (13) she encouraged Appellee to cultivate a better relationship with his parents, R. 3023, l. 2; (14) she would drive Appellee to his parent's home, R. 3023, l. 12-13; (15) Appellee would talk about sex daily, R. 2077, 12-14, R. 3023, l. 14-25; R. 2524, 1; (16) Appellee told her that Appellant's vagina needed to be tightened, R. 3025, l. 1-7; (17) she took Appellee to a physician who prescribed anti-depression medications, R. 3026, 1-10; (18) Appellee got in bed with Appellant's best friend while Appellant was nine months pregnant, R. 3026, l. 17-22; R. 2527, 1-9; (19) Appellee sexted with the best friend, R. 3027, l. 10-16; (20) Appellant was ridiculed by her Utah friends for getting pregnant, R. 3028, l. 17-20); (21) Appellant was a nurturing mother, R. 3029, l. 9-25; (22) Appellee did not help care for the child, R. 3030, 11-23; R. 3031, l. 1-6; R. 3033, l. 17-25; 3034, l. 1-4; (23) the child adjusted well to living in different places, R. 3031, l. 7-13; (24) the child and Appellant lived with Appellant's parents and maternal grandparents, R. 3031, l. 20-21; (25) Appellee's mother threatened

getting a protective order against her, R. 3032, 7-25; (26) she did not report the sexual assault by Appellee to the police because Appellee's threats intimidated her, R. 3311, l. 3-13; (27) Appellee concocted a story to protect himself about the rape by suggesting that a burglar had broken into the home and had raped her, R. 3317, l. 10-12; R. 2640, 19-23; (29) the atmosphere in the Day home was wholesome, R. 3321, l. 2125; (30) her husband was very angry when he had heard about Appellee raping her, wanted to report the incident to the police, and to kick Appellee out, R. 3322, l. 8-24; the Days didn't because they were afraid of Appellee's threats, R. 3323, l. 2-7; (32) she had withheld the truth about the rape from her husband due to Appellee's threats, R. 3325, l. 7-15; and, (33) she asked Appellee not to blackmail her, R. 3391, 8.

At the UCCJEA hearing, Carrie Tippetts, Jaime's mother, testified as follows: (1) Appellee lived in her household in Utah and Massachusetts, R. 3041, l. 2; (2) Appellee reported that his parents were abusive, R. 3044, l. 23-24; (3) Appellee refused to return home, R. 3045, l. 2-6; (4) Appellee asked Appellant's parents about their sex life, R. 3048, l. 3-5; (5) Appellee's parents came to her home a few times to visit the baby, R. 3050, l. 1-10; R. 351, l. 24; (7) Appellee staged a false break-in to the residence, R. 3053, l. 1-7; R. 3055, l. 14-19); (8) Appellee had no interest in the baby, R. 3056, l. 6; R. 3058, l. 16-25; R. 3059, l. 1-8; (9) Appellee said that he approved of Appellant's parents raising the child, R.

3061, l. 23-24; (10) Appellee would get angry and destroy household property, R. 3062, l. 14; (11) Appellee called Jaime a bitch and a slut, R. 3063, l. 1-10; (12) she caught Appellee in bed with Appellant's best girl friend and walking around naked, R. 3064, l. 1-9; (13) Appellee did not want his parents raising the child, R. 3064, l. 24-25; (14) Appellee made sexual references when changing his daughter's diaper, R. 3065, l. 16-21; and, (15) Appellee regularly would threaten the family, R. 3066, l. 1-13.

Appellant's father, Mr. Aaron Day, testified as follows: (1) he tried to help Appellee as a father would, R. 3073, l. 9-11; (2) Appellee reported that he was addicted to pornography, R. 3073, l. 13; (3) Appellee reported that Eric Barnes was emotionally abusive, R. 3074, l. 6; (4) Appellee's parents permitted him to run away, R. 3074, l. 18; (5) Appellee would talk about sex regularly, R. 3076, l. 1-7; (6) Jaime told him about Appellee raping her, R. 3076, l. 20-21; (7) because Appellee threatened his family, he did not report the rape to the police, R. 3077, l. 9-14; (8) he tried to help Appellee find a job, taking him on the road, and talking to him about his pornography addiction, R. 3077, l. 17-25; (9) Appellee asked not to be on the birth certificate, R. 3079, l. 3-4; (10) Appellant helped care for the baby, R. 3079, l. 16-17; (12) he was afraid that if he reported Jaime's rape to the police, Appellee would lie about it, R. 3081, l. 3-6; and, (13) Appellee did not want to raise the baby, R. 3081, l. 15-16.

Kennedy Thompson, Appellee's girlfriend, testified as follows: (1) Appellant has never reported that Appellee raped her, R. 3086, l. 7-8; (2) Appellant did not want Appellee to touch her because he had gotten her pregnant, R. 3087, l. 11-12; (3) the Day household joked about sex about six years ago and sex jokes were still going on, R. 3089, l. 17; R. 3090, l. 7-8; (4) she heard Appellee participate in sex talk with others, R. 3091, l. 21-22; (5) the Day household had a sexually permissive environment, R. 3093, l. 8-11; (5) she made out with Appellee while Appellant was sleeping and then got into bed with him, R. 3094, l. 12-14, 24-25; (6) she made out with Appellee a handful of times, R. 3095, l. 4; (7) Appellant is a relatively private person, R. 3096, l. 11-12; and, (8) Appellant and Jaime showered in the same room with her, R. 3097, l. 4-6.

Appellant's grandfather, Tom Day, testified as follows: (1) the attorney who represented Appellant at the mediation, Ms. Ragsdale-Pollock, had only consulted with Aaron day, R. 3100, l. 10-12; (2) Jaime might be a flight risk and Jaime and Aaron were financially challenged, R. 3102, l. 1-6; R. 3103, l. 21; (3) a few days after speaking with Ms. Ragsdale-Pollock, he realized that Jaime was not a flight risk, R. 3105, l. 3-4, 16; (4) he had no concern if Appellant got custody, R. 3105, l. 22-24; (6) Aaron Day only makes $30-35,000.00 net income annually, R. 3106, l. 16-17; (7) Ms. Ragsdale-Pollock had advised him to resolve the case was by stipulating that Appellee get temporary custody, R. 3382, l. 23; (8) he never told

Eric Barnes that he would train Appellant to be a mother, R. 3383, l. 4-13; and, (9) he had no idea whether Appellant wanted to give up custody, R. 3383, l. 22-24.

Carolyn Barnes, Appellee's mother, testified as follows: (1) the child was doing fabulously while living with her and Eric, R. 3110, l. 1-6; (2) she took the child to see an ophthalmologist about an eye problem, R. 3110, l. 12-20; (3) Appellee is passive-aggressive, R. 3112, l. 8; (4) since Appellee was not at home all day on Mondays and Fridays, she cared for the child on those days, R. 3113, l. 4-5; (5) the child has a close bond with her, R. 3113, l 13-15; (6) when Appellee is home he takes care of the child, R. 3113, l. 20-21; (7) she coaches Appellee on how to care for the child, R. 3113, l. 23; (8) Appellee schedules doctor's appointments for the child, R. 3114, l. 1-4; (9) Appellee moved back to his parents' residence in June of 2012, R. 3115, l. 7-8; R. 3116, l. 18-19; R. 3116, l. 18-22; (10) Appellee has a good relationship with her, R. 3117, l. 1-3; (11) Eric calls Appellee out, R. 3117, l. 15; (12) the child loves all members of the Barnes household, R. 3117, l. 21; (13) on April 1, 2013, Appellant had told her that she had been caring for the child for two days, R. 3133, l. 6-7; R. 3122, l. 15-16; (14) Appellant told her that she was willing to give Appellee 60-70% of parent-time, R. 3122, l. 24; R. 3123, l. 1-2; (15) the parent time established by the commissioner worked well for the child, R. 3124, l 18; (16) at the start of the parties' relationship, she was concerned because Appellant and Jaime coming to see Appellee behind her back, R. 3125, l.

22-23; (17) Jaime was acting as Appellee's confidant, R. 3127, l. 4-7; (18) Appellee ran away from home, R. 3130, l. 5-15; (18) she and Eric had involuntary committed Appellee to a juvenile facility, R. 3131, l. 11-14; (19) the family had the government pay for Appellee's stay at Archway, R. 3132, l. 3-5; (21) Appellee stayed with her and Eric for a couple of weeks before running away again, R. 3132, 14-16; (22) at midnight one day, she and her husband took Appellee to emergency counsel, but he ran away, R. 3232, l. 1920; (23) she and Eric discussed what to do, but determined that it would cost too much money to have Appellee placed into a program, R. 3133, l. 12-13; (24) after he ran away, she and Eric remained in contact by texts, R. 3134, l. 3-9; (25) she inferred that Appellant wasn't engaged with the child, R. 3136, l. 1-3; (27) she and Eric allowed Appellee to move to Massachusetts with Appellant's family, R. 3137, l. 7-9; (29) Appellee had concerns that Aaron and Jaime might adopt the child, R. 3138, l. 22-24; (30) she believed that Jaime had facilitated Appellee running away, R. 3140, l. 21-22; (31) she admitted that her son lies, R. 3141, l. 24-25; (32) Appellee was rebellious, R. 3142, l. 25; (33) she heard Appellee making inappropriate sexual references, R. 3144, l. 18-21; (34) Appellee took a full load of classes when he returned home, and was also working a part- time job, R. 3146, l. 16-18, R. 3147, l. 6); (35) Appellee was taking medication because of a diagnosis of anxiety and depression, R. 3148, l. 3-10; (36) Appellee skips taking his medications regularly, R. 3148, l.

13-15; 38) she is the primary caregiver for the child, R. 3151, l. 7; (39) several members of the Barnes family discussed custody of the child with Appellant, R. 3153, l. 10-12; (40) Appellant had brought a paper for Appellee to sign, but Eric would not sign it, R. 3154, l. 1-2; (41) Appellant could not be a mother, R. 3154, l. 19-25; R. 3155, l. 1; (42) Eric suggested to Appellant that the parties mediate the custody issue, R. 3155, l. 8-10; R. 3156, l. 1-4; (43) the juvenile facility is for children who are runaways, R. 3158, l. 8-11; and, (44) she never knew where Appellee was living, R. 3159, l. 15.

Appellee testified that: (1) he recently scheduled an appointment for the child's ophthalmologist and attended the appointment, R. 3169, l. 8-11; (2) he has a loving relationship with the child, R. 3169, l. 21-25; (3) he is comfortable being a parent, R. 3172, l. 14-17; (4) his mother cares for the child three days per week, R. 3172, l. 21-25; (4) he first filed a paternity action in Massachusetts, R. 3175, l. 25; (5) he talked with Eric about filing the law suit in Massachusetts, R. 3176, l. 6; (8) when Appellant met with Appellee and Eric Barnes to discuss custody, a mediation had already been scheduled by the parties' lawyers, R. 3182, l. 16; (9) the document Appellant had brought to the meeting proposed joint legal and physical custody with him getting more than 50%, R. 3184, l. 18; (10) Appellant wanted him to sign the agreement, R. 3185, l. 1-5; (11) he saw the child infrequently, and made no effort to fly to Massachusetts, R. 3188-3195; (12) Jaime pursued him

sexually, R. 3201, l. 22-25; (13) Appellee had reported to the police that Jaime had molested him, R. 3202, l. 8; (14) Appellee's siblings have a good relationship with the child, R. 3202, l. 18-20; (15) the one week parent-time Appellant was allowed was too much for the child, R. 3202, l. 21-14; (16) Appellee was not open to a four month on four month off joint custody arrangement, R. 3205, l. 20-22; (17) all of the people in Appellant's household love the child (R. 3206, l. 17-19); (18) he was not attracted to Jaime, R. 3208, 1-2; (19) seven people lived in the Day household, and two people were retired great grandparents of Appellant, R. 3208, l. 23; (20) he had exaggerated the number of times he had sex with Jaime when he reported her to the police, R. 3209, l. 14-16; (21) Appellee admitted that the police never prosecuted Jaime, R. 3209, l. 23-25; (23) he provided interrogatory answers under oath which were inaccurate, R. 3210, l. 16-21; (24) he knew it was a crime to lie to the police, R. 3211, l. 6-7; (25) he intentionally grabbed Jaime breasts without consent, R. 3211, l. 11-13; (26) the Day household had a charged sexual environment, R. 3211, l. 11-25; (27) he watched pornography in the Day home, R. 3212, l. 8-10, 14; (28) he watched pornography in his parents' home and became addicted to it there, R. 3212, l. 20-22; R. 3214, l. 22-24; (30) Eric knew that he was viewing pornography for several years, R. 3215, l. 9-13; (31) he admitted to swatting Jaime Day's butt because it was acceptable behavior in the Day household, R. 3216, l. 11-13; (32) he had frequent consensual sex with Jaime Day,

and Jaime encouraged it, R. 3218, l. 1- 9; (33) Jaime had told him that she was raped one night while he was sleeping by a guy she had met at a dog park, R. 3221, l. 19-23; (34) he had knocked on the bathroom door on the night of the rape and found Jaime inside the bathroom sitting in a bath tub with her clothes on at 3:00 A.M. in the morning, R. 3222, l. 10-11; R. 3265, l. 1-5; (35) Jaime did not report the rape until the next day when she was driving him to school, R. 3265, l. 1-5; (36) Carrie was not involved that night, R. 3222, l. 21); (37) Jaime had told him that she had taken a knife to defend herself from the rapist, who then took it from her, who then dropped the knife, and Jaime put it in the sink, R. 3268, l. 1-19; (38) he had lied in a second interrogatory response that he had never been diagnosed with a mental illness, R. 3270, l. 1-24; (39) he had misrepresented the vehicle expenses on his financial declaration, R. 3273; (40) he walked naked in the Day home because it was normal, R. 3223, l. 9- 13; (41) he made out with Kennedy Thompson while Appellant was lying on close by, R. 3223, l. 16-25; R. 3225-26; (42) he had told the Day family about five or six times that his father might bring criminal charges against Jaime Day, R. 3277-78; (43) he discussed with Eric two or three times about bringing charges against Jaime Day for allegedly molesting him, R. 3282, l. 7-12; (44) Appellee didn't care whether the Day family would be upset by reporting Jaime to the police, R. 3282, l. 23-25, R. 3283, l. 1.6; (45) he delayed voluntarily dismissing the Massachusetts action which allowed him more time to

bond with the child, R. 3285, l. 20-25; R. 3286; (46) he acknowledged that it was a crime to testify falsely, R. 328, l. 22; (47) he admitted that he never had any physical contact with the child for about a year after he relocated to Utah, R. 3291, l. 18-25; (48) he admitted never paying any medical insurance premiums for the child, R. 3294, l. 17-19; (49) he admitted denying Appellant mid-week overnights, R. 3295, l. 14-16; (50) he tacitly admitted that he was unavailable to facilitate virtual parent-time, R 3301, l. 14-17; (51) when the child was placed in the Barnes home, the child hardly knew them, R. 3302, l. 13-15; (52) he admitted that it was not hard for the child to transition between households, R. 3303, l. 1-9; (53) he met with Jaime privately and she begged him not to report her to the police, R. 3386, l. 6-12; (54) he told her that he couldn't promise that, R. 3387, l. 8-10; (56) he told Jaime that he could not believe that she had told Appellant that he had raped her, R. 3388, l. 25, R. 3389, l. 1; (57) Appellant told him that she was sorry because Jaime had told her that he hadn't raped her, R. 3390, l. 3-4; and, (58) Jaime asked him not to blackmail him ( R. 3391, l. 8).

Eric Barnes, Appellee's father, and present counsel, testified as follows: (1) Appellee has caused him a lot of pain, R. 3331, l. 2-4; (2) his oldest son also caused him problems, R. 3331, l. 7-9; (3) Appellee deceived him after he ran away from home, R. 3332, l. 10-13; (4) he and Carolyn discussed the parties' relationship, and agreed that the Days should not encourage contact between the

parties without their knowledge, R. 3337, l. 15; (5) Jaime picked up Appellee without Eric's permission, R. 3338, l. 7; (6) Eric wrote Aaron and told him that his house rules differed from his, R. 3338, l. 17-25; (7) when Appellee ran away the first time, he was attending school, but Eric allowed him not to return home, R. 3339, l. 19; (8) he had no idea where Appellee was when he ran away the second time, R. 3340, l. 17-25; (9) after he learned that Appellee had gotten Appellant pregnant, he took a stand off approach with Appellee, R. 3241, l. 14-22; (10) Appellee at some point called Eric, said he wanted to move back home, and said he was concerned about his parental rights, R. 3343, l. 12; (12); (11) he has seen Appellee mature over time, R. 3344, l. 4-7; (12) the child is happy living with him, R. 3344, l. 10-12; (13) Appellee is caring for the child, R. 3344, l. 14-20; (14) he has a close relationship with the child, R. 1-4; (14) Tom Day had asked him to write up a stipulation whereby Appellee would get sole custody of the child and the parties would share joint legal custody, R. 3348, l. 22-23; (15) his oldest son, Jared, had run away from home for a two-week period when he was 18, R. 3351, l. 3-11; (16) Appellee had been deceptive about using the family computer to look at pornography, R. 3351, l. 12- 25; R. 3352, l. 1-12; (17) he had encouraged Appellee to file a police report against Jaime, R. 3352, l. 23-24; (18) Appellee told him that Jaime had molested him, R. 3354, l. 7-9; (19) he excused his son's lies to the police by labeling Appellee as traumatized, R. 3355, l. 12-18; (20) he blamed the Days for

deceiving him when Appellee ran away, R. 3358, l. 14-15; (21) he never went to the Days' home to check to see if Appellee was living there, R. 3358, l. 16-17; R. 3359, l. 1-4; (22) he told Appellant's attorney that he believed the child was homeless, R. 3364, l. 10-18; (23) he discussed Appellee's allegations of molestation with Appellant's attorney, and said that if the case went to trial, he would be presenting Appellee's testimony about the alleged molestation, R. 3364, l. 21-25; R. 3365, l. 1-5; (24) he talked to Appellant directly about the case, R. 3368, l. 18; and, (25) he knew that Appellant was represented by counsel at the time, R. 3368, l. 16-25; R. 3369, l. 1-3.

The court had also ruled that the deposition testimony of Appellant' former attorney, Candace Ragsdale-Pollock, would be part of the record in the UCCJEA proceeding. R 896, ¶3; R. 679. The court referred to that testimony in its 2014 findings. R. 1057, ¶9. During her deposition, Ms. Pollock testified that at the parties' mediation and at a prior conference, Eric Barnes had threatened Jaime with prosecution if Appellant did not sign over custody. She also testified that when she and Appellant started the mediation, their goal was for Appellant to get primary physical custody of the child. However, due to the threats, Appellant agreed to reduced custody. R. 691, p. 49, 17-25, p. 50, 1-21; R. 691, p. 52, 13-19; R. 696, p. 69, 2-25; R. 698, p. 801, 8-16; R. 701, p.89, 20-24; R. 701, p. 91, 22-24; R. 701, p. 92, 1-7. The agreement awarded Appellee primary physical custody and Appellant

parent-time pursuant to U.C.A. § 30-3-35.5, and the agreement was a deposition exhibit. R. 141, ¶6, 8.

### *C. THE EVIDENCE AT THE RELOCATION HEARING*

The Commissioner entered a written recommendation (R. 1881). Among other things, the commissioner drew an erroneous inference and found that because Appellant had not filed any contempt actions, the parties must have been getting along fairly well (R. 1889, ¶11(n)). However, Appellant testified that she did not file contempt actions because her family could not afford to do so. R. 2232, 19-25; R. 2233; R. 2287, 12-16.

During the subsequent, evidentiary hearing, the judge cut off cross-examination of Appellant's first witness, Aaron Day. The judge stated that he would not receive testimony about any subject from any witness who had testified about that subject previously at the UCCJEA hearing. Upon Appellant's suggestion, he agreed to make the transcript of the March 25, 2014, ruling part of the relocation record. R. 2231, 7-17. Aaron Day then testified as follows: (1) the facts contained in his declaration were true (R. 2220, 23-24); (2) Appellant had wanted to file contempt actions against Appellee since the UCCJEA case order, but had no funds to do so (R. 2232-33); (3) a great deal of family and friends live in Boston to support Appellant and the child (R. 2233-34); (4) Appellant cries and gets frustrated in her communications with Appellee over child issues since the

UCCJEA order (R. 2235, 8-10; 2236, 1-12); (5) when the child had to go back to Appellee's home after visiting Appellant in Massachusetts, the child would get very upset (R. 2236, 1-25; R. 2237, 1-5); (6) the child loves to fly in airplanes (R. 2237, 9-17); (7) Appellant's family was willing to pay all of the travel costs for the child, including monthly, holiday, and summer travel if the child was allowed to relocate to Massachusetts (R. 2237, 18-25; R. 2238, 1-10); (8) the child has bonded well with family and friends in Massachusetts, R. 2238, 11-25; R. 2239, 1-3; (9) Appellant is adamant about finishing her college degree, and needs to be in Massachusetts because she is a dance and business major, and intends to open a dance studio upon graduation so that she can support the child (R. 2239, 7-16).

Appellant testified as follows: (1) she has been the child's primary caregiver since birth (R. 2243, 17-25); (2) she received a full academic scholarship to Dean College in Massachusetts (R. 2245, 2-7); (3) she would lose her academic scholarship if she stopped attending school (R. 2246, 10-15); (4) the tuition for attending Dean College annually is $35-45,000.00 (R. 2246, 16-21); (5) she is a dance and business major (R. 2246, 22-25); (6) Dean's dance program is unique because it allows her to take classes teaching children with disabilities, and the schools in Utah don't offer that program (R. 2247, 1-17); (7) the reason why she wanted to complete her degree is because she will be able to support the child by opening a dance studio (R. 2294, 14-22; R. 2250, 22-25); (8) Appellant had been

involved in dance for 17 years, and opening a dance studio has been her ambition for many years (R. 2249, 1-11); (9) the child has a passion and natural talent in dance (R. 2250, 1-6); (10) she is dating a young man, they have discussed marriage, and he has given her a ring (R. 2251, 4-22); (11) the young man is unlikely to move to Utah (R. 2253, 4-13); (12) the child has a close bond to the young man (R. 2253, 24-25; R. 2254, 1-7); (13) the parties have had a hard time communicating about the child, R. 2260, 23-25; R.R. 2261-63, 2715, 22-24; R. 2269, 1-13; (14) when Appellant came back to Utah in July of 2015, the parties shared 50-50 custody (R. 2269, 16-19); (15) under the terms of the stipulated order, Appellant was designated the primary caregiver, and had final say over all decisions regarding the child (R. 2270, 13-25; R. 2271, R. 1747, ¶1, 5); (16) after July of 2015, Appellant flew back to Massachusetts four or five times with the child for two week periods (R. 2271, 10-21); (17) it took the parties six months to create a Google calendar as required by paragraph 10 of the stipulated order (R. 2276, 13); (18) Appellee would not cooperate in having a weekly parenting meeting as required by the stipulated order (R. 2276, 23); (19) the parties have a very hard time communicating (R. 2277, 7- 23); (20) the parties were unable to use a parent coordinator pursuant to the stipulated order (R. 2278, 1-6); (21) Appellant sent a proposed parenting plan to Appellee in June of 2015, but he never signed it (R. 2280, 25; R. 2280, 1; R. 2286, 14-15); (22) the parties were under an obligation

to create a parenting plan pursuant the stipulated order (R. 1535); (23) Appellant's parents have been paying her attorney fees, but they can't afford to continue, R. 2287, 12-16; (24) Appellee refused to participate in a high conflict parenting class(R. 2290, 13-25; R. 2291, 1- 18; Ex. 2); (25) Appellee was not following the stipulated order (R. 2293, 1-5); (26) Appellant's parents did not have the money to request contempt hearings (R. 2287, 12-23; R. 2292, 1-6, 12-13, 23-25; R. 2293, 5-7; R. 2240, 4-16, Ex. 3); (27) Appellee's lawyer is Eric; (28) Appellee continued to restrict Appellant's parent- time until she relocated to Utah (R. 2294, 22-25; R. 2295, 1-5); (29) Appellee would not respect Appellant's final say authority (R. 2296, 9-13); (30) the parties have had a difficult time reaching joint decisions (R. 2296, 18-20); (31) Appellee has threatened to take Appellant back to Court (R. 2297, 1-3); (32) Appellee threatened to report Appellant to the police regarding transfers (R. 2296, 4-25); (33) Appellee, without permission, has accessed Appellant's family's accounts and passwords (R. 2298, 4-16); (34) Appellant has felt intimidated by Appellee and Eric (R. 2299, 1- 9); (35) because Appellee has not approved a parenting plan, exercising parent-time has been difficult (R. 2299, 14-25; R. 2300, 1-2); (36) Appellant would have not filed a motion to relocate if Appellee had been cooperative in exercising joint custody (R. 2301, 13-16); (37) the student to teacher ratio if better in Massachusetts than in Utah (R. 2301, 17-25; R. 2302, 1-2; (38) the child has traveled to Massachusetts since 2013 more than 25

times (R. 2303, 2-5); (39) the child loves to fly (R. 2303, 10-19); (40) in June of 2015, Appellant offered a parenting plan to Appellee which would give him much more time with the child than is allowed under U.C.A. § 30-3-37, and would pay for all of the travel (R. 2304, 1-20; R. 2313- 15); (41) the child has become upset when she has to return to Utah (R. 2304, 21- 25); (42) Appellant tries to cheer up the chid (R. 2305, 1-15); (43) Appellee doesn't play with the child that much (R. 2306, 6-18); (44) the child has an attitude after returning from Appellee's house (R. 2307, 7-16); (45) the child has many friends in Massachusetts (R. 2307, 19-25); the paternal grandparents show more interest in the child than Appellee (R. 2311, 1-13); (46) Appellant understands her "final say" power (R. 2355, 4-14); (47) Appellee delayed for several days in getting back to Appellant regarding travel itineraries for the child when she had to book a flight (R. 2358, 4-11); (48) Appellee made a big deal about Appellant wanting to drop off the child's Teddy Bear at his home (R. 2381, 9-20; R. 2402, 18-25; R. 2403, 1; R. 2804, 5-15); (49) Appellee interferes with virtual parent-time (R. 2385, 3-11); (50) Appellant assumed the role of primary caregiver from the time the child was born until April 13, 2013, (when she lost custody by coercion), and then from July 17, 2015, to the time of the relocation hearing, i.e., July 8, 2016 (R. 2389, 2-12; R. 2410, 1-7); (51) Appellee wanted to deviate from the joint custody order to take two week blocks of parent time three times, and Appellant allowed him to do so (R. 2399, 11-25); (52)

Appellee would not reciprocate with two week blocks of parent- time when Appellant wanted to (R. 2400, 1-8); (53) Appellant sent Jaime at transfers because she felt threatened by Appellee and her family (R. 2400, 9-24); 55) the bond between the child and extended family in the Massachusetts home is very strong (R. 2406, 1-25; R. 2853, 1-19); (56) the custody evaluator did not file a written report in the case (R. 2407, 20-25; R. 2854, 1-6); (57) Appellant paid Dr. Davies ½ of his retainer to write a written report, but Appellee refused to do so (R. 2408, 9-18; R. 2856, 15-17); (59) the Court's ruling made it difficult for Appellant to relocate to Utah without the support she had in Boston (R. 2416, 7-18); (60) Appellant has a very strong support system in Boston (R. 2417, 1-25; 2864-65); (61) Appellant has much less support in Utah, has been judged by her friends for getting pregnant, and is not close to her paternal grandfather, R. 2419, 8-23; R. 2420, 1-25; (62) the parties could not agree as to which kindergarten to send the child (R. 2499, 1-6); (63) both parties have had problems at times having virtual parent-time (64) (R. 2499, 11-24); and, (64) the custody evaluator came up with the idea of two months on two months off for parent time (R. 2502, 11-21).

Jaime Day testified as follows: (1) Appellant is an only child who she is extremely close to (R. 2423, 10-13); (2) Appellant's relationship with her paternal grandfather is strained (R. 2423, 16-21); (3) the Massachusetts community is far more caring than that in Utah (R. 2424, 1-18); (4) Appellant has matured in her

parenting skills (R. 2424, 19-25; R. 2871, 1-3); (5) Appellant has been asked by the young man she had been dating to marry her (R. 2425, 13-19); (6) the child enjoys flying (R. 2428, 6-15); (7) she and Aaron Day are willing to pay for all transportation expenses upon relocation (R. 2428, 16-25); (8) she would encourage the child to have a close relationship with Appellee and his family; and, (9) Appellant has a great love for dance and she is good at working with children (R. 2429, 7-11).

Appellee testified as follows at the relocation hearing: (1) at age 22, he still resides with his parents (R. 2431, 20-21); (2) he has been "working" as a self-employed, multi-level marketer for the past one ½ years (R. 2440, 16; R. 2887, 2-3); Appellee has made no money in this multi-level marketing activity (R. 2441, 4-8); (3) although enrolled in college and living with his parents, Appellee was hoping to obtain his Associates degree by the end of 2016, R. 2442, 6-7; (4) he disagrees with the child attending a charter school for kindergarten (R. 2450, 1-9); (5) Appellee admitted that he was at fault for trying to enjoy virtual parent-time when the five- year-old child by calling at 9:30 P.M. (R. 2469, 9-18); (6) Appellee did not want his name on the birth certificate (R. 2472, 14-23); (7) Appellee took no action to enroll the child in kindergarten, R. 2473, 15-17; (8) Appellee spends less than one hour weekly trying to sell product through the multi-level marketing activity, R. 2474, 5- 8; (9) Appellee was paying $150 per month rent including

utilities while he was living with his parents, R. 2475, 1-8; (10) when the court originally gave sole physical custody to Appellee, he was working 40 hours a week at a minimum wage job, and his parents were caring for the child (R. 2474, 2-20); (11) Appellee became a student at Weber State in January of 2013, and as of July of 2016, he had not obtained an Associates degree (R. 2476, 21-25); (12) Appellee was unemployed (R. 2477, 24-25); (13) Appellee has been fired from a job (R. 2478, 17-23); (14) Appellee's parents have told him that he should spend more time with the child (R. 2479, 10-16); (15) Appellee spoke disrespectfully to Appellant in his communications (R. 2482, 3-7); (16) despite testifying that Appellant had offered a two month on/two month off parenting plan: (a) Appellant's parenting plan indicated a two-week/on two-week off plan, and Appellee could produce no material evidence to contradict Appellant's evidence (R. 2480-81); (17) Appellee threatened to take Appellant back to court after the final order had been signed (R. 2482, 8-12); (18) despite the final order stating that Appellant had decision making authority for the child's dance programs, Appellee told Appellant that he did not want the child to go to a school that had a dance program (R. 2482, 17-25, R. 2483, 1-2); (19) Appellee listed the child's surname as Barnes when he applied for Medicaid without Appellant's permission (R. 2483, 17-25; R. 2484, 1); (20) Appellee never submitted a parenting plan to Appellant as required (R. 2485, 15- 19); (21) Appellant allows the child to speak with Appellee

by virtual parent time (R. 2487, 9-11); (22) Appellee told Appellant's parents that he wanted them to adopt the child when the child was first born (R. 2495, 2-4); and, (23) when Appellee lived with Appellant's family, his care giving to the child was minimal (R. 2496, 14-25).

***D. FACTS REGARDING THE MARSHALING REQUIREMENT***

In his ruling on March 25, 2014, the judge found that he had a significant concern about the ability of Petitioner to 'give first priority to the welfare of the child,' because Appellant had wanted to obtain a college degree by way of a full academic scholarship (so that she could care for the child financially and obtain a degree without going into debt $140,000.00, (R. 1060, ¶15). Appellee testified that: (1) Jaime Day had begged him not to tell anyone about their sexual relationship, not to report their activities to the police, and that she loved him (R. 2198, 7-14); (2) Jaime had told Appellant that she had been raped by Appellee, that it only happened once, that he was appalled by Jaime's lies, that he would not promise Jaime that he would not report what had happened, and that Jaime was frustrated about Appellee's position (R. 2200, 1-14); (3) Appellee denied that he had concocted the burglary story by making a record and texting Jaime that he could not believe that she had lied about the rape incident (R. 2201, 1-6); (4) Appellee had agreed that Appellant could have four days of virtual parent-time while she was living in Massachusetts (R. 2382, 24-25; R. 2383, 1-4); (5) when Appellant

has gotten virtual parent-time, the exchange between mother and child has gone well (R. 2384,10-25); (6) on occasion when Appellee has wanted to enjoy virtual parent-time, he has been unable to do so due to problems on Appellant's end (R. 2385, 12-18); and, (7) Appellee was flexible in terms of allowing Appellant four or five times of extended parent- time to return with the child to Massachusetts after a final, stipulated order had been entered in the UCCJEA case (R. 2392, 7-18).

Appellee also testified: (1) Appellee lives with his parents and brothers and sisters who have a good relationship with the child (R. 2433-35); (2) several extended family members live close by (R. 2437); (3) Appellee loves his daughter and spends time with her (R. 2437, 23-25; R. 2438, 1-8); (4) Appellee has worked as an intern (R. 2441, 21-25); (5) the child's life has "collapsed" since Appellant returned to serve as primary caregiver in July of 2015 (R. 2445, 23-25; R. 2890, 1-9); and, (6) the child attends the LDS primary program in Utah (R. 2447, 1-8).

As discussed supra, Carolyn and Eric Barnes's testimonies painted a picture of the child being very happy living in Utah with them, that Appellee was maturing generally and as a young father, and that he actively participated in caring for the child. Appellant incorporates those facts here.

## SUMMARY OF ARGUMENT

Appellant was denied due process when, upon remand, the court used the findings of a prior temporary order in a UCCJEA action in an ensuing relocation

action, and despite this court stating that the judge had misapplied Civil Rule 108. The Court's findings in the relocation action are also inadequate, and existing authority mandates relocation.

## ARGUMENT

### I. THE RELOCATION HEARING DENIED APPELLANT DUE PROCESS.

Under the United States and Utah constitutions, a parent has a fundamental liberty interest in raising her child. U.C.A. § 62A-41-201(1)(a). In an action involving an objection to a hearing commissioner's recommendation, a parent is provided procedural due process protection by mandating that a judge allow the parent to present evidence on issues relating to custody, and that the judge make independent findings. Utah R. Civ. P. 108(d)(3)(A) and (f).

Here, the judge ostensibly denied Appellant due process when he: (1) barred testimony from witnesses who had previously testified in the UCCJEA action (R. 2221, 17-25; R. 2222, 6-7; R. 2226, 1-2; R. 2228, 4-5, 9-10; R. 2228, 15-18; R. 2231, 1-17); and, (2) used the findings in the temporary order he had issued two years earlier as the primary basis for denying relocation. R. 2745.

This conclusion comports with other authority associated with child custody proceedings. In the relocation context, what is in the best interest of the child should be the primary focus of the court. U.C.A. § 30-3-37(4). Additionally, as

here, when parties have stipulated to custody and there has been no full adjudication of custody on the merits, a stipulation for a particular custody arrangement may be at odds with the best interests of the child. Elmer v. Elmer, 776 P.2d 599, 603 (UT 1989). That is because a stipulation may fortuitously benefit a party rather than benefitting the child due to a parent losing her resolve, being stressed out, or as here, being low on funds. Id.

Here, when Appellant filed a relocation motion under U.C.A. § 30-3-37 (21 months after the 2014 temporary order had been entered), instead of conducting an open, plenary hearing in accordance with Civil Rule 108(d)(3)(A), the Court relied upon its findings in its temporary order of April 25, 2014 – which did not involve the testimony of the custody evaluator – among other things. R. 1960-61. Therefore, the evidentiary hearing of April 25, 2014, must be viewed only for what it was – a non-binding temporary order which addressed temporary custody of the child and parent-time prior to an adjudication of the issue on the merits. Yet the judge treated his findings for that ruling essentially as dispositive of the relocation issue, and indicated that since nothing had changed since then, he would not allow relocation. R. 1961. Appellant had warned the court of its error in her Rule 54(b) motion. R. 1323.

Additionally, even in the context of a petition to modify a decree (which Elmer involved), where custody has been determined previously by stipulation or

default, the material change of circumstances rule should not be rigidly applied. Id. "A child should not be subjected to spending the rest of his or her minority in an inferior environment because of the inaction of one parent at the time custody is awarded . . . " (or by a misapplication of law by a judge in this setting). Id. A fortiori, as here, where the more stringent material change in circumstances standard does not apply in the relocation context, and where the judge erroneously used the findings in a temporary order (which merged with the stipulated final order under res judicata) as the basis for denying relocation under the material change in circumstances criteria (R. 2745), it follows that the ruling: (1) defies the parent's fundamental liberty interest and procedural due process protection afforded under Civil Rule 108(d)(3)(A); (2) is inapposite to Elmer and its progeny; and, (3) is not in the best interest of the child. Clearly, Appellant did not have a fair hearing and ruling – for a second time – and this error was also not harmless.

**II. THE FINDINGS ARE GROSSLY INADEQUATE.**

In the child custody context, findings are adequate only if they are sufficiently detailed and include enough subsidiary facts to disclose the steps by which the ultimate conclusion on each factual issue was reached. Rayner v. Rayner, 316 P.3d 455, 460, ¶11. The clearly erroneous standard applies. Robertson v. Robertson, 370 P.3d at 572, ¶5.

Review of the evidence indicates definitively that the District Court findings are grossly inadequate. The Court's findings entered on February 29, 2019 (R. 2738), made bare conclusions without discussing at any reasonable length the great deal of conflicting, material evidence which could have lead to different possible interpretations and a different outcome. The findings also failed to consider all of the factors stated in U.C.A. § 30-3-37(5), although acknowledging the catchall phrase in paragraph four, that the court may consider "any other factor." R. 2740. The Court then referred to the statutory factors found in U.C.A. §§ 30-3-10 and 10.2 and in Administrative Rule 4-903 – which were considered to a certain extent in the Court's ruling entered in April of 2014, but were not applied substantively in the ruling entered on February 20, 2019.

The Court then in paragraph three of its conclusions of law incorporated its findings of April 25, 2014, into the findings entered on February 20, 2019. R. 2745. Consequently, if this court determines that the judge did not err in incorporating the findings for the April 25, 2014, hearing into the relocation ruling, it is necessary to review the 2014 findings as they apply to the evidence presented in both the UCCJEA and relocation hearings.

Therefore, assuming arguendo that there was no error to do so, Appellant begins by a review of the 2014 findings. For the most part, the 2014 findings only determined whether the commissioner's recommendation was correct under the

misunderstanding that Appellant had the burden of proof to show that the recommendation was wrong. R. 1052, 1056, 1058. The 2014 findings do not address the criteria for relocation as set forth in U.C.A. § 30-3-37. Therefore, the 2014 findings are suspect of being correct.

Indeed, the court's focus on the best interest of the child in the 2014 findings was simply to see whether the parents could co-parent in a joint custody temporary arrangement rather than whether it was in the best interest of the child to relocate with her mother in Massachusetts. R. 1057, ¶8, ¶12. The findings also do not address the evidence for Appellant's relocation, and the ability of the parents to facilitate parent-time across the country – given Appellant's willingness to pay for air travel for the child and Appellee – factors which are mandated by U.C.A. § 30-3- 37.

Additionally, the 2014 findings misapply the evidence presented in the UCCJEA and relocation hearings. In paragraph six, the findings state that the evidence presented on Jaime's rape was meager and uncorroborated. However, as discussed infra, the testimonies of Jaime, Appellant, Carrie, and Appellee on this issue imply that Appellee was lying, and that his credibility generally was an issue.

In paragraph six, the judge followed the commissioner's conclusion that because Jaime did not report the rape to the police, and because no rape charge was brought, Appellant had not carried her burden of proof to show that the rape

occurred. R. 1056, ¶7. However this conclusion failed to weigh Appellant's corroborating evidence from Aaron, Jaime, Appellant, Carrie, Eric, and Appellee that: (1) Eric and Appellee had threatened the Day family over the rape incident; and (2) their intimidation had frightened the Day family into not reporting the rape (R. 2954, l. 17-21; R. 3081, l. 3-6; R. 2936, 2-6); (3) Massachusetts authorities had spoken to Appellant about extraditing Appellee for prosecution there ( R. 2989, l. 21-25 - R. 1299, l. 1-4); (4) Jaime saw a therapist over the rape (R. 2954, l. 17-21); and, (5) Appellee had a motive to and did report Jaime to the police over the rape incident (R. 3208, 1-3). Additionally, paragraph 11– regarding the Barnes family's lack of coercion in getting Appellant to turn over custody – was also erroneous in light of the evidence stated supra. R. 1058.

Paragraph eight of the 2014 findings follows the commissioner's erroneous "status quo" argument. However, in Taylor v. Ellison, 263 P.3d 448, 452, ¶10 (UT App. 2011), this court stated that in the context of a long-standing custody arrangement held by a primary caregiver, the best interests of the child policy suggests that custody should remain with the primary caregiver in the context of temporary custody. However, the commissioner and then the judge ruled that Appellee – who had custody of the child for a far less time than Appellant and who was not the child's primary caregiver – should have custody of the child to maintain the deal that was struck by coercion. This finding repudiates Taylor and

did not maintain the status quo. Additionally, paragraph 18 erroneously focused on the child's ties to Utah rather than on the best interest of the child in remaining with her primary caregiver. R. 1052.

Paragraph 10 of the 2014 findings acknowledges that the findings do not have the benefit of the custody evaluator's report and that the findings are only temporary. R. 1058. Yet the judge went on to principally rely on those findings when he ruled on the relocation motion.

Paragraph 13 of the 2014 findings stated that the parties worked sufficiently well together to enjoy joint custody. However, the findings also acknowledge that Appellee was not cooperative, and that continued non-cooperation might result in Appellant being awarded sole custody. R. 1060. Nevertheless, the evidence showed that the parties could not cooperate effectively. The judge's findings (which once again mirrored the commissioner's finding, R.1889, ¶11(n)) that the parties got along well with each other was not supported by the testimonies of Appellant, Aaron Day, and even Appellee, R. 2276, 13, R. 2276, 23, R. 2277, 7- 23,R. 2278, 1-6,R. 2280, 25; R. 2280, 1; R. 2286, 14-15, R. 1535, R. 2287, 12-16, R. 2290, 13-25, R. 2291, 1-18; Ex. 2, R. 2293, 1-5, R. 2287, 12-23, R. 2294, 22-25; R. 2295, 1-5, R. 2296, 9-13, R. 2296, 18-20, R. 2297, 1-3, R. 2296, 4-25, R. 2298, 4-16, R. 2299, 1-9, R. 2299, 14-25; R. 2300, 1-2, R. 2301, 13-16, R. 2358, 4-11, R. 2469, 9-18, R. 2485, 15-19; R. 2235, 8-10; 2236, 1-12, R. 2260, 23-25; R.R. 2261- 63,

2715, 22-24; R. 2269, 1-13. Therefore, the judge's use of the 2014 findings illustrates that his conclusions regarding relocation, albeit sparsely sprinkled with some material evidence – did not conform to existing authority, and did not weigh all material evidence.

Switching now to the findings entered on February 20, 2019, in paragraph 26, the Court focused heavily on Appellant's ability to give first priority to the child. R. 2745. This was a theme which the Court had originally found in paragraphs 14 and 15 of the 2014 findings. R. 1060. However, this factor found in U.C.A. § 30-3- 10.2(2)(b) (regarding a joint custody award), pertains to the ability of a parent to make shared decisions with the other parent – not the reason for the parent's relocation. Indeed, the court made its "failure to give first priority" finding because Appellant elected to finish her college degree at a private Boston college rather than returning to Utah to complete her degree here – thus abdicating her role as a mother. However, the Court's findings never gave considered weight to Appellant's testimony on this issue. Appellant testified that her college's dance program is unique because it allows her to take classes teaching children with disabilities, and the schools in Utah don't offer this kind of program, R. 2247, 1-17. The Court failed to weigh the economic realities of having to pay for a college degree at a private college, having to provide for the child upon graduation, and that Appellant – not Appellee – was assiduously working to achieve the

objective of financial responsibility and independence by earning a college degree that she found satisfying so that she could support her child immediately upon graduation. In contrast, Appellee's testimony indicated that he was much farther behind in achieving an ability to financially care for the child, R. 2474, 5-8, R. 2475, 1-8. R. 2474, 2-20, R. 2476, 21-25, R. 2477, 24-25, R. 2478, 17-23.

The court failed to weigh nearly all of the other "catch all" statutory factors (although it mentioned the need to do so in the legal standard section of its relocation ruling). R. 2740-41. This ruling effectively mandated Appellant at the age of 21, to drop out of her scholarship degree program, relocate and to live in Utah to enjoy primary custody of her child.

Additionally, the findings only obliquely touched on the neutral factors of the parties' maturity (paragraph 22), their ability to work together (paragraph 23), that the child was too young to express her wishes (paragraph 19), and that the parties' bonding to the child was equally strong (paragraph 25).

However, the Court failed to acknowledge and weigh the following evidence and statutory factors, that: (1) the child had lived with Appellant and her family for the first 2 ½ years of her life, that Appellant had played an active role in caring for the child as the primary caregiver, and that the child had a loving and supportive support system in Massachusetts (also admitted to by Appellee) (this is a material factor pursuant to Robertson, 370 P.3d at 574, ¶11; Hudema, 989 P.2d at 499, ¶26;

U.C.A. § 30-3-10(2)(m)), R. 3206, l. 17-19, R. 2243, 17-25; R. 2238, 11-25; R. 2239, 1-3; R. 2307, 19-25; R. 2311, 1-13, R. 2424, 1-18; (2) after meeting with the custody evaluator at the Rule 4-903 conference, Appellee stipulated that Appellant would enjoy primary caregiver designation upon relocating to Utah and would have final say in the legal custody context, R. 1531 (paragraph 1 and 4); (3) the child was happy and thriving while living with Appellant and her extended family in Utah and Massachusetts, R. 3206, l. 17-19; R. 2233-34, R. 2238, 11-25; R. 2239, 1-3, R. 1682, ¶17, 18, R. 2406, 1-25; R. 2853, 1-19; R. 2954, l. 7-8; (this is a material factor; Id; Rule 4-903(4)(E); (4) the developmental needs of the child (Rule 4- 903(4)(A); (5) the character and moral standards of the parties were improperly or prematurely weighed in the 2014 findings (Rule 4-903(4)(F)(iii); U.C.A. §30-3- 10(2)(d); (6) the evidence associated with the reasons for having both parents relinquishing custody did not jive with the findings (Rule 4-903(4)(F)(Viii; U.C.A. § 30-3-10(2)(h)) (where the Court did not consider that Appellee had abandoned the child for almost a year when he relocated from Massachusetts to Utah to live with his parents and did not properly weigh the Barnes's family's intimidation evidence); (7) the child's strong bond with Appellant's extended family in Massachusetts (Rule 4-903(4)(F)(x); U.C.A. § 30-3-10(2)(l); (8) Appellant's financial responsibility in completing her degree and Appellee's slowness in achieving financial independence (Rule 4-903(4)(F)(xi) (the Court

actually found in paragraph 27 of its findings that Appellant's attendance at college was not in the child's best interest); (9) evidence of domestic violence against Appellant and her mother in the household where the child lived (U.C.A. § 30-3-10(2)(a)); (10) Appellee did list himself on the birth certificate, R. 2472, 14-23; (11) Appellant's college's dance program isn't offered in Utah, R. 2247, 1-17; (12) Appellee had no interest in raising the child initially, R. 3056, l. 6; R. 3058, l. 16-25; R. 3059, l. 1-8, R. 3030, 11-23; R. 3031, l. 1-6; R. 3033, l. 17-25; 3034, l. 1-4, R. 3081, l. 15-16; and, (13) Appellant's family was willing to pay all travel costs for the child, including monthly, holiday, and summer travel (R. 2237, 18-25; R. 2238, 1-10; R. 2304, 1-20; R. 2313-15, R. 2428, 16-25, R. 2237, 18-25; R. 2238, 1-10.

As to this last point, U.C.A. § 30-3-37(5)(c) required the Court to consider the economic resources of the parents in fashioning adequate parent-time with the child and their abilities to facilitate long distance travel.

Additionally, the Court also failed to consider the coercive effect on Appellant by Eric Barnes, as an attorney, speaking to Appellant shortly before the mediation – when she was represented by counsel – on how that exacerbated the other threats. Comment 2 to Professional Rule 4.2 states that this rule attempts to protect the integrity of the legal system by restricting the possibility of over reaching and bearing down on a party. This fact should not be winked at, but

enforced. Paragraphs eight and nine of the 2014 findings don't address this evidence. R. 1056-57. Indeed, in light of Appellee – shortly after returning to Utah – reporting Jaime to the police – indicates a strong willingness by Eric to protect his son, and to use coercion to overreach. Additionally, Appellee and Eric admitted that they threatened the Day family. R. 3277-78; R. 3282, l. 7-12; R. 3352, l. 23-24; R. 3364, l. 21-25; R. 3365, l. 1-5.

Additionally, paragraph nine of the 2014 findings states that the court independently found that coercion was not a "driving force" for Appellant turning over custody. R. 1058. However, Appellant's former lawyer had testified by deposition that Eric had threatened Jaime if Appellant did not turn over custody. R. 691, p. 50, 8; R. 691, p. 52, 15; R. 696, p. 69, 2-25; R. 698, p. 801, 8-16; R. 701, p.89, 20-24; R. 701, p. 91, 22-24; R. 701, p. 92, 1-7. Given that Appellant had come to the mediation as the primary caregiver with Appellee having no significant contact with the child, it is reasonable to infer that the threats against Jaime were indeed the driving force which coerced her to give Appellee primary custodian status.

Additionally, the moral standards of the parties is a statutory factor, and is material to the extent that they may affect a child's best interests. Robertson, 370 P.3d at 572, ¶6. Here, Appellant provided evidence that Appellee had raped her, had raped her mother, had lied to the police in reporting the alleged rape, had

grabbed her mother's breast, was in the habit of walking naked in the house where the child lived, was in the habit of grabbing or swatting her and her mother's butt in the house where the child lived, was addicted to and watched pornography in the home where the child lived. Therefore, evidence which pertained to Appellee's moral standards was material for this young girl child who primarily lives with him.

Although the Court mentioned the moral character factor in paragraphs 6 and 12 of its 2014 findings, the Court improperly weighed the evidence. Generally, a Court's findings implicitly reflect the weighing of witnesses' credibility. State ex rel. A.R. v. State, 2017 UT App. 153, 402 P.3d 206, 214 ¶26. Yet not only do the findings fail to comment on any witnesses' credibility, since the evidence regarding the rape was conflicting and material as to Appellee's moral character, the findings needed to address the witnesses' conflicting testimony.

It is apparent that from the testimonies of Jaime Day, Carrie, and Appellee regarding the rape incident that someone was lying. Based upon the evidence, it is reasonable to infer that Appellee was lying. If so, then Appellee's testimony should have been discredited, and his moral standards became material.

Here, Carrie, a mature woman, and the great-grandmother of the parties' child, testified that she could hear glass breaking and banging on the downstairs bathroom door. She ran to see what caused the commotion. When she arrived at the

bathroom, Tyler was banging on the door, and told her that someone had broken into the house. R. 3053, 2-7. Carrie doubted Appellee from the get-go. R. 3053, 16-20; R. 3055, 20-22. When Carrie got the bathroom door open, Jaime was lying in the bathtub with her clothes on, glass was broken all around, and Jaime was crying uncontrollably R. 3055, 14-19. Carrie could not get Jaime to tell her what happened, but Tyler had taken Carrie outside of the residence and showed her a knife from the alleged intruder. R. 3055, 14-19. Appellee, upon returning to live with his attorney father, filed a report with the police, alleging that Jaime had molested him – thus ostensibly covering his crime by preemptive strike. R. 3054, 4- 8.

Jaime testified that Appellee had filed a police report against him for having sexual intercourse with him more than 100 times. R. 3009, 19-21; R. 3014, 1-2. However, the police did not refer the case for prosecution. R. 3013, 23-24. While Appellee was living with the Day family, Appellee got on top of her in her bed while she was sleeping one evening. R. 3015, 25; R. 3016, 1-3. Appellee threatened her by telling her that if Jaime reported the incident: (1) Appellant would never forgive him; (2) Appellee's parents would put him in juvenile facility; and, (3) Jaime would be prosecuted. R. 3016, 5-9.

Upon cross-examination Appellee testified as follows: (1) he and Jaime had sex multiple times in the Day residence. R. 3207, 3-15; (2) in his report to the

police, he said he had sex with Jaime about 100-200 times. R. 3208, 1-3; (3) seven people lived in the Day household when he was having sex with Jaime. R. 3208, 23; (4) Carrie and her husband Mike lived in the Day household and were retired. R. 3208, 24-25, R. 3209, 1-4; (5) deleted (6) he exaggerated the number of times that he had sex with Jaime when he spoke to the police. R. 3209, 14-16; (7) Jaime took advantage of him by convincing him to have sex with her even though he found her unattractive, R. 3209, 18-22; (8) the police did not refer the case for prosecution, R. 3209, 24-25; (9) he admitted to grabbing Jaime's breasts, but said that it was normal to do so in the Day household, R. 3211, 11-21; (10) sex between Jaime and himself was consensual, R. 3217, 21-25; (11) he was not old enough to consent, R. 3218, 11-13; (12) regarding the time when he found Jaime in the bathtub, he was told by Jaime that there was a burglar in the house, R. 3221, 1-3; (13) Jaime showed him the knife that the burglar used, and it was in the sink, R. 3221, 14-16; (14) Jaime claimed that she was raped the night that she showed him the knife by a "guy she had met at a dog park," R. 3221, 17-23; (15) he denied banging on the bath room door, but admitted that he was knocking on the door at 3:00 A.M., R. 3222, 1-11; (16) Jaime opened the door to let Appellee come into the bathroom, but Carrie was not involved in the incident, R. 3222, 20-22; (17) he awoke around 3:00 A.M. by the sound of water, R. 3264, 22-25; R. 3265, 1-5; (18) deleted (19) he only had sex with Jaime 20-30 times because he's a male and she's

a female and "it's natural to be aroused," R. 3263, 23-25, R. 3264, 1-3; (20) the Day family had dogs, but he was not aroused by dog barking despite Jaime's alleged claim of rape, R. 3265, 17-20; (21) at first he stated that he and Carrie had looked to see if the intruder had pried open the door to the residence, then he changed his testimony to not remembering if Carrie was there, R. 3265, 24-25; R. 3266, 1-5; (22) Jaime told him that the intruder had raped her the following day when she drove him to school, R. 3266, 6-9; (22) he reported the incident to Aaron the next day, R. 3267, 5-8; (23) Jaime had grabbed a knife when she heard a sound and the intruder who was about six feet tall, grabbed her from behind and pulled her into a room, R. 3268, 8-12; and, (24) the intruder took the knife from Jaime, dropped it outside, Jaime retrieved it, washed it, and put the knife in the kitchen sink, R. 3268, 14-16).

The testimony about the rape conflicts in material ways between the three witnesses and should have been reflected in the findings. If the Court had credited Carrie's and Jaime's testimonies, there would have been time for Appellee to place the knife near the residence, and show Carrie the knife as a ploy to cover up his rape of Jaime moments earlier.

Additionally, it is reasonable to infer that Appellee was lying about raping Jaime even from his own testimony. That is, even assuming that he woke up by water running in the bathroom at 3:00 A.M., why would he have gotten up and

knocked on the bathroom door – not suspecting that an intruder had entered the house? Why did Jaime not scream out for help – given there were dogs and seven people living in the household? Why would the intruder rapist have dropped the knife near the residence with his finger prints on it providing evidence to the police of his identity for prosecution? The answer is that Appellee's version of the facts associated with the rape doesn't hold water. This conclusion is supported by Eric and Carolyn Barnes's testimony who admitted that Appellee has deceived and lied to them, R. 3332, l. 10-13; R. 3141, l. 24-25, and by Appellee's admissions about lying in his discovery responses – despite having the assistance of counsel, R. 3270, l. 1-24, R. 3273; R. 3269, 11-25; R. 3270, 1-25; R. 3271-73.

In sum, the findings did not properly consider and weigh this conflicting and material evidence.

**III. THE RELOCATION RULING IS ERRONEOUS.**

Appellant marshals the evidence to prove that the ruling lacks substantial evidentiary support when viewed in the light most favorable to Appellee. Wilson v. Sanders, 2019 UT App. 126, ¶16-17.

Appellant incorporates by reference the facts stated in her Statement of Facts which support the ruling. The testimonies of Eric, Carolyn, and Appellee about the child doing well now while living in the Barnes home although relevant, should be considered as neutral – given the equitable concerns of coercive transfer by a Utah

lawyer who violated the professional rules. Secondly, Appellant's family has also provided an equally stable and loving home for the child. Additionally, the court's findings and temporary order in 2014 indicate that the judge credited Appellant's "significant testimony" on the issue of Appellee's moral character by ordering that he take a psycho-sexual evaluation. R. 1064, ¶3.

Applying the evidence to U.C.A. § 30-3-37, it is apparent that on balance relocation should have been allowed under the abuse of discretion standard. Robertson, 370 P.3d at 573, ¶9. Of relevance is the reason for the move. U.C.A. § 30-3-37(5)(a). Appellant had a good reason relocate to Massachusetts with the child. She was not a Utah resident, and neither was the child when the UCCJEA action was brought. The court made residency an issue by incorporating its 2014 ruling into the relocation ruling. Appellant had been the child's primary caregiver since birth and would have remained such but for the coercive transfer. Since Appellant relocated to Utah in July of 2015 and enjoyed primary caregiver status and final say authority under the UCCJEA final order, Appellee's involvement remained less important through the time of the court's relocation ruling in July of 2016. R. 1531, ¶1, 5.

Appellant also had the child flown to Massachusetts regularly so that the child continued to have a close bond with the Day family. R. 2303, 2-5; R. 1060, ¶16. Additionally, the 2014 temporary order came with the caveat that Appellee

should only enjoy primary custody if he lived with his parents and his parents were willing to help care for the child. R. 1063, ¶1. Around this time, Appellee was working and taking a full load of credits at college. R. 3146, l. 16-18, R. 3147, l. 6. Thus, this case is distinguishable from cases where a parent actually served as the primary caregiver to merit that designation.

Appellant lived with her family as well while finishing college. Therefore, her caregiver status was similar. At the time of the relocation hearing her support system in Massachusetts was much stronger there. However, notably, her extended family had the economic resources to allow the child to have a significant amount of parent-time with her father by paying for air travel above that which was required under the relocation statute. Appellee made no such offer. This statutory factor was not weighed in the February 20, 2019, order. R. 2738; U.C.A. § 30-3-37(5)(b) and (c). Appellant also showed an incredible loyalty to her daughter by relocating to Utah for a year after the UCCJEA matter was settled by taking her college classes on line (R. 2269, 16-19), and living with her paternal grandfather whom she had a strained relationship (R. 2423, 16-21; R. 2419, 8-23; R. 2420, 1-25). The child's educational opportunities were better in Massachusetts because of the student to teacher ratio (R. 2301, 17-25; R. 2302, 1-2); Rule 4-903(4)(A).

The court also failed to consider that the shift to the Barnes home was a huge change for the child to living with virtual strangers (R. 3302, l. 13-15), and that

neither Appellee nor the court disagreed that Appellant had been the primary caregiver of the child since birth, R. 2243, 17-25, R. 1061, ¶17. All of these facts prove that the judge's persistence in finding that Appellant' decision to finish college in a dance program that is not available in Utah so that she can support her daughter does not comport with existing Utah authority. Robertson, 370 P.3d at 574, ¶11; Hudema, 989 P.2d at 499, ¶26; U.C.A. § 30-3-10(2)(m)). Indeed, if anything: (1) the initial transfer of custody of the child to the Utah residents uprooted the child from her secure footing in Massachusetts; and, (2) because of Appellant's continued efforts to cultivate and maintain a close bond with the child to her and her family in Massachusetts, the child will not suffer any harm in transferring back now to the loving, Day home, R. 2303, 2-5. Indeed, the initial transfer to the Barnes family conflicts with the authorities cited which state that maintaining stability for the child is of paramount concern.

The moral character was a huge issue because there was evidence of rape, sexual assault, lying in discovery responses, threats, fraudulent police reports, accessing without permission the Day family's accounts and passwords ( R. 2298, 4-16), and coercive conduct.

Additionally, there was evidence that Appellee was diagnosed with depression and anxiety, was prescribed mediation, regularly failed to take his medication, was committed for emotional problems, lied to his parents, and is

passive aggressive. R. 3270, l. 1-24; R. 3148, l. 13-15; R. 3112, l. 8; R. 3131, l. 11-14; R. 3144, l. 18-21. This statutory factor was not weighed as well. R. 2738. Rule 4-903(4)(F)(iv).

Additionally, there was substantial evidence and the court found that Appellant did not cooperate materially in the co-parenting format. R. 2280, 25; R. 2280, 1; R. 2286, 14-15; R. 1535; R. 1059-60; R. 2276, 13; R. 2276, 23; R. 2277, 7- 23; R. 2278, 1-6; R. 2294, 22-25; R. 2295, 1-5; R. 2296, 9-13; R. 2296, 18-20; R. 2297, 1-3; R. 2358, R. 2381, 9-20; R. 2402, 18-25; R. 2403, 1; R. 2804, 5-15; R. 2385, 3-11; R. 2408, 9-18; R. 2856, 15-17; R. 2482, 17-25, R. 2483, 1-2.

Finally, it seems that the court's ultimate basis for awarding Appellee custody temporarily – given that the child had loving homes to live in – was the child's ties to Utah. R. 1062, ¶18. However, the Court clearly used the wrong standard under U.C.A. § 30-3-37 (which applies by the court's incorporation of that ruling to the relocation ruling). Indeed, the court's thinking superficially mirrors that found in Pingree v. Pingree, 365 P.3d 713, 716, ¶9. However, Pingree is distinguishable because the Court mentioned the child's ties to Utah there only because that's where the child's life had been. However, here, Jaime, Aaron, Carrie, her husband, and Appellant all reside in Massachusetts. The child moved to Massachusetts when she was around one year old. R. 1958, l. 5-9, i.e., December 2011. The coercive transfer occurred in April of 2013. Appellee lived with the Day

household and finished high school in Massachusetts. The child has continued to have a significant contact with the Day family since the transfer. Appellant's contact with her great grandfather where the court ordered her to live in Utah is strained. Therefore, the court 's reasoning on the Utah ties issue is also incorrect as a matter of fact.

In sum, both parents were finishing college when the relocation hearing occurred. Both grandparents provided support to their granddaughter in caring for the child. However, the other factors tip the scale for relocation, i.e., on the moral character issue ( sexual activity, lying, intimidation, false reports to the police), Appellant was more emotionally stable, there are better schools in Massachusetts, Appellant closer to graduating from college, the forced adjustment to the Barnes household, the coercive transfer, the unethical conduct by Appellee's father, and Appellee's lack of cooperation in co-parenting.

## CONCLUSION

The Court's ruling should be reversed and relocation allowed.

Dated this 3rd day of September, 2019.

s/ Theodore R. Weckel
Counsel for Appellant

## CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify that on the 3rd day of September, 2019, a true and correct copy of Appellant's opening brief was served upon counsel for the Appellee, Eric B. Barnes, by first class mail to the following address: 47 N. Main Street, Kaysville, UT, 84037, and by email at: eric@elderlaw-info.com.

s/ Theodore R. Weckel